



SUMMARY OF THE TALK

The Industrial talk on 5 November, where Mr. Patrick Thong - PPG's SAP COE Operation Stream Lead for APAC - walked us through what PPG is all about. He gave us a clearer picture of the company's culture and spent quite a bit of time on the idea of "One PPG". It's their way of emphasizing unity and accountability, and it comes with a simple but powerful message: "run it like we own it". In other words, everyone is encouraged to step up, take initiative, and treat their responsibilities like they genuinely matter.

After that, the session shifted toward how enterprise systems work in real industry environments. Mr. Patrick broke down the concept of Enterprise Resource Planning (ERP) and explained how SAP helps huge organizations like PPG connect different business functions so operations run smoothly and leaders can make informed decisions. He also talked about the SAP Center of Excellence (COE) and its various operation streams, which handle system stability, ongoing improvements, and global processes behind the scenes. Before wrapping up, he shared some advice about career opportunities in the SAP world. It's field with strong demand and plenty of room to grow, especially for those who want a skill set that stays relevant across industries.

HIGHLIGHTED CONTENT

Mr. Patrick explained about the implementation history by applying SAP in PPG. He highlighted that the biggest change for PPG is between 2018 and 2025 as they are changing from SAP S/4HANA to SAP S/4HANA Cloud because of location and environment. Mr. Patrick also explained how Process flow in PPG to us and dividing the process into **4 main streams**. For example, stream **Demand to Replenish (DTR)** covers SAP Modules for Materials Management (MM), Production Planning (PP), Quality Management (QM), Extended Warehouse Management (eWM), and Environment, Health and Safety (EH/S). Next, for **Stream Order to Cash (OTC)**, it covers SAP modules for Sales and Distribution (SD). Furthermore, stream **Procure to Pay (PTP)** covers modules for Material Management (MM), and Vendor Invoice Management (VIM). Lastly, stream **Record to Report (RTR)** covers modules for Financial Accounting/General Finance (FI), Controlling incl. Product Costing (CO), General Ledger (GL), Account Payable (AP), Account Receivable (AR), and Fixed Asset (FA). After explaining how SAP works flow in PPG, Mr. Patrick also encouraged all of us to consider choosing SAP as a career. Why? Because by pursuing a career in SAP, we can create a global impact, take advantage of the high demand for SAP professionals today, and contribute to increased innovation and technology leadership.



SAFIYA NURSYAHADAH BINTI MASNOOR (A23CS0176)

The talk gave me a much clearer picture of how ERP and SAP actually function in real industry, especially within a large global company like PPG, and it helped move my understanding from theory to real application. I also found the "One PPG" culture inspiring because it emphasized teamwork, ownership and responsibility in a way that felt authentic. As a year 3 Data Engineering student, it made me realize how valuable SAP skills are in today's job market and showed me the range of career opportunities within SAP COE operations. Overall it was a practical and eye-opening session that encouraged me to explore ERP skills that can strengthen my data engineering background.

YASMIN BATRISYIA BINTI ZAHIRUDDIN (A23CS0201)

By the end of this session, I was truly amazed by how SAP and ERP work in real industries, such as in the global coatings company PPG. The session enhanced my understanding of SAP and ERP after listening to the real-world applications. I am genuinely inspired to become part of the PPG Digital IT Team, especially in the SAP CoE Operations project, just like Mr. Patrick's team. His sharing about his experiences really opened my eyes to the opportunities within this IT team. He also advised us on the skills needed to join the PPG Digital IT team, and I'm excited to work on developing those skills so that I, too, can become part of the team in the future.